Nivela 3D

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Mini Guide to Selling on Etsy and Amazon

A step-by-step guide to listing your 3D printed pieces on the two biggest online marketplaces in the US — with the right price, good photos and no headaches.

Information checked in November 2026. Marketplace rules and fees change: always confirm in the official seller dashboard before listing.

Part 01

Etsy or Amazon Handmade?

Both can work for 3D printing, but they reward different things.

	Etsy	Amazon Handmade
Buyers	Shoppers looking for unique, personalized and gift items. Strong for custom names, décor and niche designs.	Shoppers already on Amazon who want a handmade version of something. Strong search traffic, higher price expectations for quality.
Getting in	Open a shop and list. Pay per listing.	You must apply and be approved as an artisan; items have to be made by hand or with your own design and process.
3D printing rule	Since June 2025, 3D printed items must be based on **your own original design**. Files from third parties do not qualify, even with a commercial license.	Your products must be made, altered or designed by you. Check the Handmade category rules before listing 3D prints.
Reputation	Star reviews and Star Seller criteria (fast replies, on-time shipping with tracking, great reviews).	Customer reviews plus Account Health metrics (late shipments, cancellations, defect rate).

Tip: start with one channel, learn the routine (listing → sale → shipping → review) and only then open the second one.

Part 02

How much to charge on each channel

Marketplaces take a **percentage** of every sale, often **plus a fixed amount**, and the fee usually applies to shipping too. These rules change from time to time — so this guide teaches you how to find your real fee instead of just promising a number.

Step 1 — Find your exact fee

- **Etsy (US, checked Nov 2026):** $0.20 listing fee per item (renews every 4 months or when it sells), 6.5% transaction fee on the item price *plus shipping*, and payment processing of 3% + $0.25. If a sale comes from Etsy's Offsite Ads, an extra 15% applies (12% for shops above $10,000 a year). Check your Payment account → Fees for your country's rates.
- **Amazon Handmade:** the monthly Professional selling fee is waived and Amazon takes a referral fee of 15% (or $0.30, whichever is greater) on the total price, including shipping. If you use FBA, fulfillment and storage fees are added.
- Write down: **percentage** + **fixed amount per item or order** + **any shipping you absorb**.

Step 2 — Add the channel in Nivela 3D

Under **Costs & channels**, add "Etsy" and "Amazon Handmade" with the percentage and fixed fee you found. In the calculator, pick the channel: the suggested price already keeps your margin intact.

Step 3 — Check the result

Illustrative example (made-up numbers, just to show the math): a piece that costs $9.00 to make, sold on a channel that charges 10% + $0.45 per item. To keep 45% profit, the price needs to be **$21.00** — not $13.05, which is what you get by adding 45% on top of the cost. That gap is exactly why so many "sold" pieces lose money.

Golden rule: never use your direct-sale price (Instagram, local, word of mouth) on a marketplace. Price per channel.

Part 03

Listings that sell

Photos

- Clean, neutral background (white, light gray or light wood). Marketplaces recommend a white or light background for the main photo.
- Natural window light, no flash. Avoid harsh shadows.
- Main photo: the whole piece, centered, filling most of the frame.
- Show scale: the piece in a hand, next to a familiar object or with a ruler.
- Show it in use: the vase with a plant, the stand holding the headset, the keychain on keys.
- Take a close-up of the finish — it builds trust.
- If you offer several colors, one photo with all of them side by side.
- A short video (5–15 seconds) of the piece turning or in use helps a lot on Etsy.

Title

- Start with what people type: the product name ("Geometric Vase", "Headset Stand").
- Then the details that change the choice: size, color, material, quantity in the set.
- Add "3D printed" when it helps — many buyers search that way.
- Never use brands, sports teams, characters or franchises you're not licensed to use.
- Skip empty words like "cute", "best" or "sale" and piles of symbols.

Example: Geometric 3D Printed Vase 6 in Sage Green Modern Planter for Succulents

Description and tags

- First line: the main benefit in one sentence.
- Exact dimensions (height x width x depth) in inches (and cm if you sell abroad) and weight.
- Material and what it's good for (indoor, decorative, functional).
- Available colors and how to choose.
- Production time for made-to-order items.
- Care: keep away from strong sun and heat (e.g. inside a car), how to clean.
- Explain that fine layer lines are part of 3D printing — it prevents complaints.
- On Etsy, use all 13 tags with phrases buyers actually search ("personalized keychain", "desk organizer").

Part 04

Packaging and shipping

- Delicate pieces (keychains, miniatures) in a bag + box, never loose in an envelope.
- Fill empty spaces (crumpled kraft paper, bubble wrap) so the piece doesn't move.
- Test: shake the closed box. If anything moves, add protection.
- A thank-you card asking for a review noticeably boosts ratings.
- Keep 2 or 3 standard box sizes — it makes shipping costs and stock easier.
- Buy labels through the marketplace when possible: tracking is uploaded automatically and it counts toward on-time shipping.

Part 05

Processing times and reputation

Set processing times you can always meet

Both Etsy and Amazon let you set a processing (handling) time for each listing. For made-to-order pieces, set a realistic number of business days instead of the shortest option — late shipments hurt your reputation more than a slightly longer wait.

Etsy — Star Seller

Etsy's Star Seller badge is based on fast message replies, on-time shipping with tracking and a high average review rating over the last three months. It's not required to sell, but it's a good checklist for running a healthy shop.

Amazon — Account Health

Amazon tracks metrics such as late shipment rate, pre-fulfillment cancellation rate and order defect rate. Falling outside the targets can lead to warnings or a deactivated account, so ship on time and

don't cancel orders you've accepted.

Part 06

Watch out for brands and characters

- Characters, team logos, brands and franchises are protected intellectual property.
- Buying or downloading an STL file doesn't automatically give you the right to sell the prints. On Etsy, since June 2025, 3D printed items must come from your own original design.
- Marketplaces remove listings reported by rights holders and can suspend accounts after repeated violations.
- Prefer your own designs and keep your design files and sketches as proof of authorship.

Part 07

Business basics: taxes and paperwork

You can start as an individual (sole proprietor), but as sales grow it pays to get organized. In most US states, Etsy and Amazon collect and remit sales tax on marketplace orders for you; you're still responsible for income tax on your profit and any local business license your city or state requires. Keep a record of every sale and cost — the Nivela 3D sales log helps here.

Recommendation: talk to an accountant or your local Small Business Development Center (SBDC) about registering your business and how to report marketplace income.

Part 08

Checklist before publishing

☐ I calculated the real cost of the piece (material, electricity, wear, failures, labor, supplies).

☐ I added the marketplace fee in Nivela 3D and checked the price that keeps my margin.

☐ The design is my own (required on Etsy for 3D printed items).

☐ The title starts with what the buyer searches for and uses no third-party brands.

☐ Main photo on a light background, piece centered.

☐ The description has dimensions, material, colors, lead time and care.

☐ Packaging tested and shipping calculated with the right box.

☐ Quick replies saved for the most common questions.

☐ The processing time is one I can always meet.

Official sources (Nov 2026)

Etsy — Fees & Payments Policy: etsy.com/legal/fees
Etsy — Creativity Standards: etsy.com/legal/creativity

Amazon — Handmade: sell.amazon.com/programs/handmade
Amazon — Selling fees: sell.amazon.com/pricing